

Network Troubleshooting Simulation

Revised PBQ Answer Key with Explanations

Scenario summary: All devices should be on VLAN 10. The working devices should be marked "No Problem," and only devices with an actual fault should have a corrective action selected.

Device	Correct Problem	Correct Solution	Why this answer is correct
Switch 1	No Problem	N/A	There is no indication of a cabling, VLAN, or addressing issue on Switch 1, so no change is needed.
Switch 2	No Problem	N/A	Switch 2 is also operating as expected. Since no fault is identified, selecting a fix would be incorrect.
Server	No Problem	N/A	The server is functioning normally in the simulation, so the best troubleshooting choice is to leave it unchanged.
PC1	No Problem	N/A	PC1 has no listed fault condition. Because it is already working properly, no repair action should be selected.
PC2	Open cable detected	Replace cable	An open cable means the physical connection is broken somewhere in the run, so replacing the faulty cable is the correct fix.
PC3	No Problem	N/A	PC3 is not showing a wiring, VLAN, or configuration problem, so "No Problem" is the correct diagnosis.
PC4	Wrong VLAN	Change VLAN assignment	The instructions say all devices should be on VLAN 10. If PC4 is on the wrong VLAN, it will not communicate correctly until its VLAN assignment is changed.
PC5	Connector on backward	Replace cable	A cable with a connector terminated backward is a

			physical-layer wiring fault. The practical correction is to replace the bad cable.
PC6	No Problem	N/A	PC6 is operating as intended, so no corrective action should be applied.

Scoring note: Devices with "No Problem" should not have a solution selected. Only the three faulty endpoints - PC2, PC4, and PC5 - require corrective action.